DAILY READING • 样张

The Last Shot at Korva

2026-11-12 · 当天 50 词全部覆盖 · 全文 602 词 · 5 段

短文

Sefa had worked the upper bench at Korva for six years, and she knew the altitude by the way her ears clicked. The quarry was closing within weeks, and the financial report on the wall showed a surplus of crushed stone nobody wanted to buy. Under the new regulation every shot had to be logged by noon, with one entry for the charge and one for the weather. Her certificate had expired in March, and the contrast between the paperwork and the rock face had stopped amusing her. She would not depart from the routine of six seasons, and she chose to devote the last weeks to leaving the bench clean. Minimum staffing made her the surveyor, the radio operator and the keeper of the diesel ledger.

By seven the survey stakes were still wet, and the clay around them was sticky enough to pull a boot off. The drill bits had soaked overnight in a bucket of oil, and Besnik wiped each one with the same slow cloth. Mathematics had never been her strength, but the charge calculation was arithmetic she could check twice. He was skilled enough to work without looking at his hands, and his patience with the slow part seemed infinite. She had to adjust the angle of the third hole, and the dozer blade had to be pulled back from the edge. Every hammer blow came back as an echo off the far wall, where one particle of dust hung in the harsh light.

On the morning of the shot she ran her thumb over the crack in the enamel mug and let the coffee wait. The regulator's guideline asked for an exclusion zone of four hundred metres, and she enlarged it by fifty. A small modification to the timing would let the audio warning run a full minute before the current reached the caps. She switched the radio to the backup channel when the first one went deaf, and the truck lifted over a bump in the track. Two boxes slid against the rear of the cab. An experimental delay of forty milliseconds was worth one attempt, and by ten the climb had exhausted her.

Her sister Alma was pregnant with a second child and lived in the third house past the weighbridge. Generally the village tolerated the blasting, but on Tuesday a crowd gathered over unpaid wages and for an hour it looked like a riot. The foreman tried to discourage them with talk

of the police, and Besnik only shrugged at the noise. There was a contradiction in the survey that nobody could explain, since two readings of the same face sat eleven centimetres apart. She did not utter a word until the crowd had thinned, and she did not hesitate when the foreman asked her to go down. His modesty was real, but his genius was in his hands.

At eleven the execution of the plan took nine minutes and no more. They had encountered a band of wet clay under the third row, which changed nothing except the colour of the dust. The reduction in the charge was thirty percent, enough to keep the fly rock inside the line. Afterwards she tried to quantify the dust with a white card, then chose to integrate the two surveys into a single sheet. Small problems arise in every shot, namely a torn hose or a loose cap, and the result was still satisfactory. They went back to their respective tasks without being told, and a boy at the fence gave her a thumbs up as a symbol that the village had heard the difference.

解析 · 行间留白，可直接手写

Sefa had worked the upper bench at Korva for six years, and she knew the altitude by the way her ears clicked. The quarry was closing within weeks, and **the financial report** on the wall showed a surplus of crushed stone nobody wanted to buy. **Under the new regulation** every shot had to be logged by noon, with one entry for the charge and one for the weather. Her certificate had expired in March, and the contrast between the paperwork and the rock face had stopped amusing her. She would not **depart from the routine** of six seasons, and she chose to devote the last weeks to leaving the bench clean. Minimum staffing made her the surveyor, the radio operator and the keeper of the diesel ledger.

> **the financial report** 财务报告 financial 只作定语修饰 report / year / trouble，不作表语；「财务困难」说 in financial trouble
>
> **Under the new regulation** 按新条例 regulation 指成文规章，介词常用 under / against；作「管理」义时不可数，不加 a
>
> **depart from the routine** 背离既有的做法 depart 作「背离」时须带 from，后接被放弃的对象；不带 from 只表示「离开某地」

By seven the survey stakes were still wet, and the clay around them was **sticky enough to pull** a boot off. The drill bits had soaked overnight in a bucket of oil, and Besnik wiped each one with the same slow cloth. Mathematics had never been her strength, but the charge calculation was arithmetic she could check twice. He was skilled enough to work without looking at his hands, and his patience with the slow part seemed infinite. She had to adjust the angle of the third hole, and the dozer blade had to be pulled back from the edge. Every hammer blow came back as **an echo off the far wall**, where one particle of dust hung in **the harsh light**.

> **sticky enough to pull** 黏到足以扯下…… sticky 后接 enough to do 表程度与结果；sticky 指表面发黏，gluey 更强调胶质
>
> **an echo off the far wall** 从远壁弹回的回响 echo off + 表面，用 off 表反射来源；作动词时还可写 echo with 表「回荡着」
>
> **the harsh light** 那道刺眼的光 harsh 修饰光、声音、气候时表「强烈刺人」；修饰人则表「严厉」，两个义项不要混用

On the morning of the shot she ran her thumb over the crack in the enamel mug and let the coffee wait. The regulator's guideline asked for **an exclusion zone** of four hundred metres, and she enlarged it by fifty. A small modification to the timing would let **the audio warning** run a full minute before the current reached the caps. She switched the radio to the backup channel when the first one went deaf, and the truck lifted over a bump in the track. Two boxes slid against **the rear of the cab**. An experimental delay of forty milliseconds was worth one attempt, and by ten the climb had exhausted her.

> **an exclusion zone** 警戒区，禁入区 固定搭配，zone 前用 exclusion 而非 exclusionary；同类还有 buffer zone / safety zone
> **the audio warning** 声音警报 audio 作定语修饰 signal / warning / file，强调听觉形式，不能修饰人
> **the rear of the cab** 驾驶室后部 rear 作名词须用 the rear of；作定语只前置（rear door），比 back 更书面

Her sister Alma was **pregnant with a second child** and lived in the third house past the weighbridge. Generally the village tolerated the blasting, but on Tuesday a crowd gathered over unpaid wages and for an hour it **looked like a riot**. The foreman tried to discourage them with talk of the police, and Besnik only **shrugged at the noise**. There was a contradiction in the survey that nobody could explain, since two readings of the same face sat eleven centimetres apart. She did not utter a word until the crowd had thinned, and she did not hesitate when the foreman asked her to go down. His modesty was real, but his genius was in his hands.

> **pregnant with a second child** 怀着第二个孩子 pregnant with + 胎儿，不用 in；引申义 pregnant with 表「充满（悬念、意义）」
> **looked like a riot** 看上去像要闹成暴乱 riot 可数，须带 a；look like 后接名词表「看样子要成为」，不接 as if + 从句
> **shrugged at the noise** 对那片吵闹耸了耸肩 shrug at / shrug off 表对某事不在乎；shrug 不直接接人作宾语

At eleven the execution of the plan took nine minutes and no more. They had encountered a band of wet clay under the third row, which changed nothing except the colour of the dust. The reduction in the charge was thirty percent, enough to keep the fly rock inside the line. Afterwards she tried to **quantify the dust** with a white card, then chose to integrate the two surveys into a single sheet. Small problems arise in every shot, namely a torn hose or a loose cap, and the result was still satisfactory. They went back to **their respective tasks** without being told, and a boy at the fence gave her a thumbs up as **a symbol that** the village had heard the difference.

> **quantify the dust** 把粉尘量化 quantify 直接接被量化的对象，不用 quantify on；名词形式为 quantification
> **their respective tasks** 各自的任务 respective 只作定语且总接复数名词，不能单独作表语，也没有 respectively tasks 这种写法
> **a symbol that** 一个表明……的征兆 symbol 后接 that 从句说明含义，或接 of + 名词；作「符号」时与 sign 可互换

译文

塞法在科尔瓦的上层台阶干了六年，光凭耳朵那一声「咔」，她就知道现在海拔多高。采石场几周内就要关停，墙上那份财务报告显示，碎石子堆得过剩，却没人肯买。新条例规定每一次爆破都必须在中午前登记，一条记装药量，一条记天气。她的证书三月就过期了；表格和岩面之间的那种反差，早已不再让她觉得好笑。她不愿背离六个开采季养成的规矩，于是决定把最后几周用来把台阶收拾干净。人手压到最低，她一个人兼着测量员、报话员和那本柴油账的保管人。

到七点，测量桩还是湿的，桩子周围的黏土黏得能把靴子拔下来。钻头在油桶里泡了一夜，贝斯尼克用同一块慢吞吞的布把每一根擦干。数学从来不是她的强项，但装药计算不过是算术，她可以算两遍。他的手艺熟到不必看自己的手，而对这活里最慢那一段的耐心，看上去无穷无尽。她得调第三个孔的角度，推土机的铲刀也得从崖边退回来。每一锤下去都从那面远壁上弹回一声回响，一粒粉尘就悬在那道刺眼的光里。

爆破那天早上，她用拇指蹭过搪瓷杯上的裂纹，让咖啡再等一等。监管方的指导方针要求四百米的警戒区，她往外扩了五十米。对时序做一处小小的修改，就能让声音警报在电流到达雷管之前响满一分钟。第一台对讲机哑了，她换到备用频道；卡车在车辙里颠过一个坎，两只箱子滑到驾驶室后部。四十毫秒的试验性延迟值得试一次，到十点钟，那趟爬坡已经把她累透了。

她妹妹阿尔玛怀着第二个孩子，住在过磅房那头第三户人家。大多数情况下村里忍得了爆破，但周二有人为欠薪聚在磅房前，有一个钟头像要闹成暴乱。工头拿警察来劝阻，贝斯尼克只是对那片吵闹耸了耸肩。测量里有一处谁都解释不通的矛盾：同一个掌子面的两次读数差了十一厘米。人群散尽之前，她一个字也没说；工头让她下去一趟时，她也没有犹豫。他的谦逊是真的，可他的天才长在那双手上。

十一点，方案的实施用了九分钟，一点也不多。他们在第三排下面遇到一条湿黏土带，除了粉尘的颜色，别的什么都没改。装药量减了三成，足以让飞石留在界线以内。之后她拿一张白卡想把粉尘量化，最后还是把两份测量合成了一张图。每次装药都会冒出些小毛病，也就是一根破软管或者一个松了的管帽，而结果仍然令人满意。没人吩咐，大家各自回到各自的活上；栅栏边一个男孩朝她竖起大拇指，她把它当成一个征兆：村子听出了这次的差别。